

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 884

By Hale

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Tennessee line workers, first responders, and highway and transportation crews for their brave and tireless efforts during Winter Storm Fern.

WHEREAS, it is the privilege of the members of this General Assembly to recognize those devoted Tennesseans who, in the discharge of their duties, commit long hours and often place themselves in harm's way to ensure the safety and well-being of their fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, Winter Storm Fern, which began impacting Tennessee on January 24, 2026, brought with it a dangerous mix of snow, sleet, and freezing rain that coated roads, trees, and power lines in a layer of ice, accompanied by frigid temperatures that lingered for several days; and

WHEREAS, this historic winter storm caused widespread disruption and danger across the State of Tennessee, including the closure of schools and offices, impassable roads, and extensive power outages affecting hundreds of thousands of residents from Memphis to Nashville to Knoxville; and

WHEREAS, in the face of these perilous conditions, line workers from public and private utilities across the State worked around the clock to restore power to homes and essential services, even as temperatures plummeted into the single digits; and

WHEREAS, first responders, including emergency medical personnel, law enforcement officers, firefighters, and emergency management officials, rose to meet the storm's challenges, responding to accidents, checking on vulnerable residents, and maintaining public safety under extreme conditions; and

WHEREAS, highway and transportation crews from the Tennessee Department of Transportation and local agencies toiled without rest to clear snow and ice from roads and

bridges, enabling emergency travel and ensuring supply chains remained intact during the storm's most dangerous days; and

WHEREAS, together, these courageous and tireless workers acted with integrity, skill, and determination, placing the welfare of others above their own comfort and safety; and

WHEREAS, these exemplary professionals represent the very best of public service and community resilience, and they are richly deserving of our gratitude and recognition; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the line workers, first responders, and highway and transportation crews from across the State of Tennessee for their brave and selfless service during Winter Storm Fern, extending our deepest appreciation to these heroic individuals who, in a moment of great peril, came to the aid and rescue of their fellow citizens.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.